

Foster Parent Navigator

Test plan — Michigan foster home licensing rules. Corpus: 101 rule sections across 43 active rules, current as of June 16, 2023.

Signing in

FOSTER PARENT	/signin
jbrown@example.com	Jay Brown — on Erica's caseload
erica.parent@example.com	Erica Adams — her own caseload
LICENSING SPECIALIST	/portal/signin
eadams@example.com	Erica Adams — two families
mellery@example.com	Marcus Ellery — no caseload

Password for every account: **password**. Test data only — replace before any real foster parent uses this.

1 · Should answer cleanly

One rule answers each of these directly.

QUESTION	WHAT SHOULD HAPPEN
Can I use a portable heater in a foster child's bedroom?	No — R 400.9303(2)
Can I smoke in my house if the foster child isn't home?	No — R 400.9310(1). Prohibited while a child is <i>placed</i> there, not merely present.
How many foster children can I have at one time?	8 — R 400.9401(1)(a)
Can I spank a foster child?	No — R 400.9404(3)
How many hours of training do I need each year?	6 — R 400.9416(1)
Does my swimming pool need anything special?	Yes — R 400.9301(4). Rescue equipment, local requirements.

2 · Should come back conditional

The honest answer has conditions. Watch for a flat yes or no.

QUESTION	WHAT SHOULD HAPPEN
Can a foster child share a bedroom with my own child?	It depends — R 400.9401 sets conditions on siblings, medical need and age.
Where do I keep medication?	It depends — R 400.9412(3) says properly stored <i>and</i> accessible as appropriate, not simply locked away.

Can I use a portable heater?

It depends — no location given. It should name the boundary rather than guess.

3 · Should escalate

Real questions the rule corpus cannot answer. Escalating is correct, not a bug.

QUESTION	WHAT SHOULD HAPPEN
Can my foster child sleep over at a friend's house?	Specialist review — MDHHS policy FOM 722-03F, not yet loaded.
How often does my licensing worker have to visit?	Specialist review — Child Placing Agency rules, a different rule set.
Can I take my foster child out of state?	Specialist review — Interstate Compact, not loaded.

4 · The two that matter most

Each has a tempting wrong answer that would pass every automatic check.

SPACE HEATER — A “NO” HERE IS A FAILURE

“Can I run a space heater in the living room while the kids are awake?”

The rule prohibits portable heaters *in bedrooms* and is silent about anywhere else. If the answer is **No**, the system has invented a prohibition that does not exist — while quoting R 400.9303(2) perfectly. The quote is real, so the verbatim check passes. Nothing automatic catches this.

RESCINDED RULE — THE HONEST ANSWER IS “THAT RULE IS GONE”

“What are the requirements for exits from the home?”

R 400.9307 covered exits and was **rescinded in 2023**. Confidently citing an exit requirement means reaching for law that has been repealed.

5 · Confidentiality check

For the licensing specialist. This is a claim the app makes; here is how to verify it.

SIGN IN AS MARCUS ELLERY

Sign in at `/portal/signin` as `mellery@example.com`. His queue should be **empty**, even though Jay Brown has asked questions and sent escalations sitting in the same database.

Then, as Erica, escalate something from a parent account and try to open it while signed in as Marcus by pasting the `/portal/<id>` URL. It should bounce back to his own empty queue.

The sign-in screen promises a foster parent that their specialist sees only what they explicitly send. This is how that promise gets checked rather than trusted.

6 · Questions for Erica, not for the app

- Is “your specialist sees only what you send” the right promise? Would an agency accept not being able to browse a family’s question history?
- Does *It depends* read as genuinely helpful, or as the app dodging the question?
- Would you send a real foster parent here tomorrow? If not, what is missing?
- Which of these answers felt **more certain than it should have been**?

THE ONE THING TO FLAG

Over-abstention is annoying. **Over-confidence about what the law says is the failure that could hurt a family.** Any answer that sounded more certain than the rules support is worth more than any answer that was simply wrong.

Answers come from Michigan Administrative Code R 400.9101–400.9506, effective June 16, 2023, published by the Michigan Department of Health and Human Services. MDHHS policy manual sections are parsed but not yet in use.